

Workbook Activity: My Hearing Challenges Checklist

Check any situations where you notice difficulty hearing or understanding.

Conversations

- ☐ One-on-one conversations
- ☐ Group conversations
- ☐ Family gatherings
- ☐ Conversations with children
- ☐ Conversations with soft-spoken people
- ☐ Conversations when someone speaks from another room
- ☐ Conversations when the speaker is not facing me

Background noise

- ☐ Restaurants
- ☐ Coffee shops
- ☐ Cars
- ☐ Work meetings
- ☐ Social events
- ☐ Religious or community gatherings
- ☐ Stores or public places

Technology and media

- ☐ Phone calls
- ☐ Video calls
- ☐ Television
- ☐ Movies
- ☐ Music
- ☐ Public announcements
- ☐ Alarms, timers, or doorbells

Emotional or daily-life impact

- ☐ I feel tired after listening for a long time
- ☐ I avoid certain social situations
- ☐ I feel frustrated when I miss words

- I worry that others think I am not listening
- I ask people to repeat often
- I pretend to understand when I do not
- I feel less confident in conversations

Reflection Questions

- 1. The three situations where I have the most difficulty hearing are:
 1. ---
 2. ---
 3. ---
- 2. The people I most want to communicate better with are:
- 3. One listening situation I want to improve first is:
- 4. One question I want to ask my audiologist is:

Key Takeaway

Hearing loss is not just about making sounds louder. It can affect speech clarity, listening effort, confidence, relationships, safety, and daily participation. Understanding your hearing loss is the first step toward managing it well. With the right support, many adults with hearing loss can communicate more confidently and stay connected to the people and activities that matter most.

Workbook: My Work and Public Places Communication Plan

Part 1: Where do I need support?

Check the places where hearing is difficult.

- ☐ Work meetings
- ☐ Phone calls
- ☐ Video calls
- ☐ Training sessions
- ☐ School or classes
- ☐ Medical appointments
- ☐ Pharmacies
- ☐ Banks or offices
- ☐ Restaurants
- ☐ Theaters
- ☐ Airports or train stations
- ☐ Places of worship
- ☐ Community events
- ☐ Public service counters
- ☐ Emergency or safety announcements
- ☐ Other: _____

My top three difficult places are:

- 1. ---
- 2. ---
- 3. ---

Part 2: What makes these places difficult?

Check what applies.

- ☐ Background noise
- ☐ Speaker is far away
- ☐ People talk over one another
- ☐ Poor lighting
- ☐ Speaker turns away
- ☐ Room echo

- Fast speech
- Phone sound is unclear
- Video-call audio is unclear
- Public announcements are hard to hear
- I miss names, numbers, or times
- I cannot see the speaker's face
- I feel tired from listening
- I do not know what support to ask for

The biggest barrier for me is:

Part 3: Supports I want to try

Check the supports that may help.

- Written instructions
- Email summaries
- Meeting agendas
- Meeting notes
- Captions for video calls
- Captioned phone option
- Remote microphone
- Assistive listening device
- Telecoil or hearing loop
- Preferential seating
- Quiet room or quieter seating
- Visual or vibrating alerts
- Text alerts
- One-speaker-at-a-time rule
- Communication partner support
- Other: _____

The first support I want to try is:

Part 4: My work communication plan

At work, I have difficulty with:

- Meetings

- Phone calls
- Video calls
- Training
- Group discussions
- Safety announcements
- Customer, client, or patient conversations
- Conversations in noise
- Informal conversations
- Other: _____

One specific work barrier is:

A support that may help is:

A phrase I can use:

Part 5: My appointment plan

Before medical or professional appointments, I will:

- Tell the office I have hearing loss
- Bring hearing aids or assistive technology
- Bring a communication partner if desired
- Ask for written instructions
- Prepare questions in advance
- Ask for a visit summary
- Use the patient portal for follow-up

During the appointment, I will:

- Ask the provider to face me
- Ask for rephrasing when needed
- Repeat back important information
- Ask for names, numbers, or instructions in writing
- Ask for clarification before leaving

One phrase I can use at appointments is:

Part 6: My public places plan

In public places, I will ask about:

- Assistive listening systems

- Captions
- Written information
- Quiet seating
- Accessible announcements
- Visual alerts
- Telecoil or hearing loop access
- Other: _____

A phrase I can use is:

Example:

"Do you have an assistive listening system or written information available?"

Part 7: My self-advocacy scripts

Practice these phrases.

- "I have hearing loss. Please face me when you speak."
- "Could you write that down?"
- "Could you send that by email?"
- "Could you turn on captions?"
- "Can we move away from the noise?"
- "Please speak one at a time."
- "I missed the last part. Could you rephrase it?"
- "Let me repeat that back to make sure I understood."
- "Could you put the date and time in the chat?"
- "Is an assistive listening system available?"

My own script:

Workbook: My Emotional Wellness and Hearing Plan

Part 1: How hearing loss affects me emotionally

Check any statements that feel true.

- ☐ I feel frustrated when I miss words.
- ☐ I feel embarrassed when I misunderstand.
- ☐ I feel tired after listening for a long time.
- ☐ I avoid noisy places.
- ☐ I avoid group conversations.
- ☐ I feel left out sometimes.
- ☐ I worry people think I am not listening.
- ☐ I feel anxious before social events.
- ☐ I feel less confident than I used to.
- ☐ I feel sad about changes in my hearing.
- ☐ I get irritated when people speak from another room.
- ☐ I pretend to understand sometimes.
- ☐ I feel overwhelmed by hearing aids or hearing technology.

The hardest emotional part of hearing loss for me is:

Part 2: My listening fatigue signs

When listening becomes tiring, I notice:

- ☐ I feel mentally tired
- ☐ I get irritated more easily
- ☐ I stop participating
- ☐ I need quiet time
- ☐ I get headaches
- ☐ I miss more information
- ☐ I feel stressed
- ☐ I avoid conversation
- ☐ I rely on others to explain
- ☐ I pretend to understand

One sign that I need a listening break is:

Part 3: Situations I avoid

Check any situations you avoid because hearing is difficult.

- ☐ Restaurants
- ☐ Family gatherings
- ☐ Parties
- ☐ Work meetings
- ☐ Phone calls
- ☐ Video calls
- ☐ Religious or community events
- ☐ Medical appointments
- ☐ Group conversations
- ☐ Public places
- ☐ Conversations with unfamiliar people
- ☐ Other: _____

One situation I want to participate in more confidently is:

A support or strategy that may help is:

Part 4: My support system

People who can support me include:

- ☐ Audiologist
- ☐ Primary care provider
- ☐ Ear, nose, and throat specialist
- ☐ Spouse or partner
- ☐ Children
- ☐ Grandchildren
- ☐ Friends
- ☐ Coworkers
- ☐ Caregiver
- ☐ Counselor or mental health provider
- ☐ Support group
- ☐ Other: _____

One person I can talk to about my hearing is:

One thing I want them to understand is:

Part 5: Self-advocacy phrases

Practice phrases that may reduce stress.

- "Please face me when you speak."
- "I heard part of that, but I missed the last sentence."
- "Can you say that another way?"
- "Can we move somewhere quieter?"
- "Please do not speak from another room."
- "Can you write that down?"
- "I want to be included, but I need one person to speak at a time."
- "Let me repeat that back to make sure I understood."
- "I need a short listening break."

My own phrase:

Part 6: My emotional wellness plan

One hearing-related situation I want to improve is:

One communication strategy I will try is:

One technology or tool I want to ask about is:

One person I will ask for support is:

One question I want to ask my audiologist is:

One question I want to ask my healthcare provider or counselor is:

Workbook: My Personal Hearing Care Plan

Part 1: My hearing summary

My hearing loss type is:

- ☐ Conductive
- ☐ Sensorineural
- ☐ Mixed
- ☐ I am not sure

My right ear hearing is:

- ☐ Normal
- ☐ Mild hearing loss
- ☐ Moderate hearing loss
- ☐ Moderately severe hearing loss
- ☐ Severe hearing loss
- ☐ Profound hearing loss
- ☐ I am not sure

My left ear hearing is:

- ☐ Normal
- ☐ Mild hearing loss
- ☐ Moderate hearing loss
- ☐ Moderately severe hearing loss
- ☐ Severe hearing loss
- ☐ Profound hearing loss
- ☐ I am not sure

My word recognition was explained to me:

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ I am not sure

My audiologist's main explanation was:

Part 2: My top listening goals

The three listening situations I most want to improve are:

- 1. ---

- 2. ---
- 3. ---

The people I most want to communicate better with are:

The activity I want to participate in more confidently is:

Part 3: My hearing technology plan

I currently use:

- ☐ No hearing technology yet
- ☐ Prescription hearing aids
- ☐ Over-the-counter hearing aids
- ☐ Cochlear implant
- ☐ Bone-conduction device
- ☐ Remote microphone
- ☐ TV streamer
- ☐ Phone streaming
- ☐ Captioned phone
- ☐ Smartphone captions
- ☐ Visual or vibrating alerts
- ☐ Telecoil or hearing loop
- ☐ Other: _____

Technology I want to ask about:

- ☐ Hearing aids
- ☐ Hearing aid adjustment
- ☐ Remote microphone
- ☐ TV streamer
- ☐ Phone streaming
- ☐ Captioning tools
- ☐ Alerting devices
- ☐ Assistive listening systems
- ☐ Cochlear implant evaluation
- ☐ Hearing protection
- ☐ Other: _____

My most important technology question is:

Part 4: My communication strategy plan

Strategies that help me:

- ☐ Face the speaker
- ☐ Move closer
- ☐ Reduce background noise
- ☐ Improve lighting
- ☐ Ask for rephrasing
- ☐ Ask people not to speak from another room
- ☐ Ask people to speak one at a time
- ☐ Repeat back important information
- ☐ Ask for written instructions
- ☐ Use captions
- ☐ Plan ahead for difficult listening situations
- ☐ Take listening breaks

The strategy I want to practice most is:

A phrase I can use is:

Part 5: My family and support plan

People I want involved in my hearing care:

- ☐ Spouse or partner
- ☐ Adult child
- ☐ Friend
- ☐ Caregiver
- ☐ Coworker
- ☐ Healthcare provider
- ☐ Other: _____

One thing I want them to understand about my hearing is:

One thing they can do to help is:

Part 6: My follow-up plan

My next audiology appointment is:

Date: _____

Reason for visit:

- Hearing test
- Hearing aid fitting
- Hearing aid follow-up
- Hearing aid adjustment
- Assistive technology discussion
- Medical referral follow-up
- Hearing protection
- Other: _____

Questions I want to ask:

- 1. ---
- 2. ---
- 3. ---

Part 7: Symptoms I should report

I will contact a healthcare professional if I notice:

- Sudden hearing loss
- Sudden change in hearing
- Hearing loss in only one ear
- Major difference between ears
- Ear pain
- Ear drainage
- Dizziness or vertigo
- New or one-sided tinnitus
- Ear fullness that does not go away
- Hearing loss after head injury
- Hearing aids suddenly stop helping
- Other: _____

Part 8: My hearing protection plan

Places where I may need hearing protection:

- Concerts
- Sporting events
- Power tools

- Yard equipment
- Motorcycles
- Loud music
- Workplace noise
- Firearms
- Sirens
- Other: _____

My hearing protection plan is:

Part 9: My long-term tracking plan

I will pay attention to:

- Asking for repetition more often
- Turning up the TV more
- More difficulty in noise
- More difficulty on the phone
- Avoiding social situations
- More listening fatigue
- New tinnitus
- New dizziness
- Ear pain or drainage
- Hearing aids not helping as much
- Family noticing more difficulty

If I notice changes, I will:

Part 10: My personal hearing care statement

My hearing care goal is:

One step I will take this month is:

One step I will discuss with my audiologist is:

Workbook: My Audiogram Reflection Page

Part 1: My hearing test results

My right ear hearing is:

- ☐ Normal
- ☐ Slight hearing loss
- ☐ Mild hearing loss
- ☐ Moderate hearing loss
- ☐ Moderately severe hearing loss
- ☐ Severe hearing loss
- ☐ Profound hearing loss
- ☐ I am not sure

My left ear hearing is:

- ☐ Normal
- ☐ Slight hearing loss
- ☐ Mild hearing loss
- ☐ Moderate hearing loss
- ☐ Moderately severe hearing loss
- ☐ Severe hearing loss
- ☐ Profound hearing loss
- ☐ I am not sure

My hearing loss type is:

- ☐ Conductive
- ☐ Sensorineural
- ☐ Mixed
- ☐ I am not sure

Part 2: What sounds are hardest for me?

- ☐ Soft speech
- ☐ Speech from another room
- ☐ Children's voices
- ☐ High-pitched voices
- ☐ Doorbell

- Phone ringing
- TV dialogue
- Speech in restaurants
- Speech in group conversations
- Public announcements

Part 3: Connecting my audiogram to real life

The three listening situations I want to improve most are:

- 1. ---
- 2. ---
- 3. ---

One question I still have is:

Workbook Activity: How Hearing Loss Affects My Life

Part 1: My daily listening situations

Check the situations where hearing feels difficult.

- ☐ Conversations at home
- ☐ Conversations from another room
- ☐ Restaurants or coffee shops
- ☐ Family gatherings
- ☐ Work meetings
- ☐ Phone calls
- ☐ Video calls
- ☐ Medical appointments
- ☐ Religious or community events
- ☐ Watching television
- ☐ Hearing children's voices
- ☐ Hearing soft-spoken people
- ☐ Listening in the car
- ☐ Public announcements
- ☐ Group conversations

Part 2: My listening effort

Check any statements that feel true.

- ☐ I feel tired after listening for a long time.
- ☐ I have to concentrate hard to follow conversations.
- ☐ I understand better when I can see the speaker's face.
- ☐ I miss more when there is background noise.
- ☐ I avoid some situations because listening is too difficult.
- ☐ I sometimes pretend I understood.
- ☐ I ask people to repeat often.
- ☐ I feel frustrated when people speak from another room.

Part 3: My relationships and communication

Hearing loss affects my conversations with:

- Spouse or partner
- Children
- Grandchildren
- Friends
- Coworkers
- Healthcare providers
- Community members
- Other: _____

One communication problem I would like to improve is:

One thing others could do to help me communicate better is:

One thing I can do to advocate for myself is:

Part 4: My safety and independence

Check any sounds or information you sometimes miss.

- Doorbell
- Phone ringing
- Timer
- Smoke alarm
- Car horn
- Siren
- Someone calling my name
- Public announcements
- Medical instructions
- Emergency alerts
- Other: _____

One safety concern I want to discuss with my audiologist is:

Part 5: My personal goals

The three areas I most want to improve are:

- 1. ---
- 2. ---
- 3. ---

The most important reason I want better hearing support is:

At my next appointment, I want to ask about:

- Hearing aids
- Hearing aid adjustments
- Assistive listening devices
- Phone or TV tools
- Captioning options
- Communication strategies
- Family education
- Hearing protection
- Medical referral
- Follow-up testing
- Other: _____

Workbook Activity: My Hearing Aid Expectations and Goals

Part 1: What I hope hearing aids will help with

Check the areas you most want to improve.

- ☐ One-on-one conversations
- ☐ Family conversations
- ☐ Group conversations
- ☐ Restaurants
- ☐ Work meetings
- ☐ Phone calls
- ☐ Video calls
- ☐ Television
- ☐ Hearing soft voices
- ☐ Hearing children's voices
- ☐ Hearing from another room
- ☐ Hearing environmental sounds
- ☐ Feeling less tired from listening
- ☐ Feeling more confident in conversations
- ☐ Participating more socially

My top three listening goals are:

- 1. ---
- 2. ---
- 3. ---

Part 2: What I understand about hearing aids

Check each statement after reviewing it with your audiologist.

- ☐ Hearing aids can improve access to sound.
- ☐ Hearing aids do not restore normal hearing.
- ☐ Hearing aids may not make every word clear in background noise.
- ☐ Hearing aids often take time to get used to.
- ☐ Follow-up appointments may be needed.
- ☐ Consistent use helps me adjust.
- ☐ Communication strategies are still important.

■ Accessories may help in difficult listening situations.

One thing I learned about hearing aids is:

One question I still have is:

Part 3: My first-month hearing aid log

Use this section after you begin wearing hearing aids.

Week 1

Average hours worn per day: _____

Situations where hearing aids helped:

Situations that were difficult:

Sounds that were too loud, sharp, or uncomfortable:

Questions for my audiologist:

Week 2

Average hours worn per day: _____

Situations where hearing aids helped:

Situations that were difficult:

Sounds that were too loud, sharp, or uncomfortable:

Questions for my audiologist:

Week 3

Average hours worn per day: _____

Situations where hearing aids helped:

Situations that were difficult:

Sounds that were too loud, sharp, or uncomfortable:

Questions for my audiologist:

Week 4

Average hours worn per day: _____

Situations where hearing aids helped:

Situations that were difficult:

Sounds that were too loud, sharp, or uncomfortable:

Questions for my audiologist:

Part 4: Questions to ask at my hearing aid follow-up

At my next appointment, I want to ask about:

- Sound quality
- Loudness
- Background noise
- My own voice
- Physical comfort
- Feedback or whistling
- Cleaning and maintenance
- Battery or charging
- Phone connection
- Television connection
- Different programs
- Remote microphone options
- Captioning tools
- Wearing schedule
- Communication strategies
- Other: _____

The most important issue I want help with is:

Workbook: My First Month with Hearing Aids

Part 1: My hearing aid goals

My top three reasons for using hearing aids are:

- 1. ---
- 2. ---
- 3. ---

Part 2: My daily wearing log

Week 1

Average hours worn per day: _____

What sounded better:

What was difficult:

Questions for my audiologist:

Week 2

Average hours worn per day: _____

What sounded better:

What was difficult:

Questions for my audiologist:

Week 3

Average hours worn per day: _____

What sounded better:

What was difficult:

Questions for my audiologist:

Week 4

Average hours worn per day: _____

What sounded better:

What was difficult:

Questions for my audiologist:

Workbook: My Communication Strategy Plan

Part 1: My hardest communication situations

- Conversations from another room
- Restaurants
- Family gatherings
- Group conversations
- Work meetings
- Medical appointments
- Phone calls
- Video calls

My top three hardest listening situations are:

- 1. ---
- 2. ---
- 3. ---

Part 2: Strategies I want to try

- Ask the speaker to face me
- Move closer to the speaker
- Reduce background noise
- Ask for rephrasing
- Repeat back important information
- Ask for written instructions
- Use captions

The first strategy I want to practice is:

Workbook: Family and Friends Communication Plan

Who are my main communication partners?

- Spouse or partner
- Children
- Grandchildren
- Friends
- Coworkers
- Caregivers
- Healthcare providers
- Community members

What I want others to understand

- I can hear speech but do not always understand the words
- I hear better when I can see the speaker's face
- Background noise makes listening much harder
- I miss more when people speak from another room
- Shouting does not always help
- Rephrasing helps more than repeating the same words
- Written information helps me remember important details
- I want to be included

What helps me most

- Say my name before speaking
- Face me when speaking
- Move closer
- Speak clearly
- Do not shout
- Do not speak from another room
- Reduce background noise
- Rephrase when I miss something
- Speak one at a time
- Write down important details

One thing I wish my family or friends understood is:

One communication habit we want to change is:

One communication habit we want to build is:

Workbook: My Background Noise Plan

Part 1: Where noise is hardest for me

- Restaurants
- Coffee shops
- Family gatherings
- Group conversations
- Work meetings
- Religious or community events
- Medical appointments
- Car conversations

My top three hardest noisy situations are:

- 1. ---
- 2. ---
- 3. ---

Part 2: Strategies I want to try

- Sit closer to the speaker
- Face the speaker
- Choose a quieter seat
- Sit with my back to a wall
- Ask people to speak one at a time
- Ask for rephrasing
- Ask for written details
- Ask my audiologist about a remote microphone

Workbook: My Hearing Technology Checklist

Part 1: Where do I need more help?

Check the areas where hearing is difficult.

- ☐ Phone calls
- ☐ Video calls
- ☐ Television
- ☐ Restaurants
- ☐ Family gatherings
- ☐ Work meetings
- ☐ Medical appointments
- ☐ Religious or community events
- ☐ Public announcements
- ☐ Doorbell
- ☐ Alarm clock
- ☐ Smoke alarm or carbon monoxide alarm
- ☐ Timers
- ☐ Hearing in the car
- ☐ Hearing one speaker far away
- ☐ Hearing in public spaces
- ☐ Other: _____

My top three technology needs are:

- 1. ---
- 2. ---
- 3. ---

Part 2: Tools I want to ask about

Check the tools you want to discuss with your audiologist.

- ☐ Remote microphone
- ☐ TV streamer
- ☐ Wireless TV headphones
- ☐ Bluetooth hearing-aid streaming
- ☐ Captioned telephone

- Smartphone captions
- Video-call captions
- Speech-to-text app
- Visual doorbell alert
- Vibrating alarm clock
- Smoke alarm or carbon monoxide alerting device
- Telecoil
- Hearing loop systems
- FM or infrared public listening systems
- Hearing-aid app
- Other: _____

The tool I am most interested in is:

Part 3: Matching the tool to the problem

Complete the chart.

My phone problem is:

Possible tool or strategy:

My TV problem is:

Possible tool or strategy:

My background noise problem is:

Possible tool or strategy:

My safety alert problem is:

Possible tool or strategy:

My public space problem is:

Possible tool or strategy:

Part 4: Questions for my audiologist

At my next appointment, I want to ask:

- Do my hearing aids connect to my phone?
- Do my hearing aids connect to a TV streamer?
- Would a remote microphone help me?

- Do I have a telecoil?
- How do I use a hearing loop?
- What captioning tools should I try?
- What can help with phone calls?
- What can help with television?
- What can help with restaurants or meetings?
- What alerting devices should I consider?
- Can you show me how to use the device?
- Are there lower-cost options?
- Can I try the technology before buying it?

My most important question is:

Part 5: Before I buy a device

Before buying, I will ask:

- What problem does this solve?
- Does it work with my hearing aids?
- Does it work with my phone or TV?
- Is it easy for me to use?
- Does it need charging?
- Does it need an app?
- Can I return it?
- Is there customer support?
- Can my audiologist help me set it up?
- Is there a simpler option?

The device I am considering is:

What I need it to help with: